SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026
Thirtieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

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SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 26 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm
Tuesday 27 Oct	Mass, 10.00am	Rosary, Castlederg: 2.00pm	Rosary, 10.00am
Wednesday 28 Oct	Liturgy of Word with Holy Communion: 10.00am	Castlederg: Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion: 10.00am Dregish: Rosary, 11.00am	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 29 Oct	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 30 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	Mass, 7.30pm
Saturday 31 Oct	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm: Induction Mass of Fr Chris McDermott
Sunday 1 Nov: All Saints Day	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am: *Additional Mass for All Saints Day* Drumnabey,12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am: *Month's Mind, Brendan Cassidy*

ST PATRICK'S, DRUMQUIN – Fr Chris McDermott will be formally inducted as Parish Priest of Langfield (Drumquin) next Saturday evening, 31 October, by Bishop Michael Router, at an Installation Ceremony at the 5.00pm Vigil Mass in St Patrick's Church.
In looking forward to welcoming Fr Chris to Drumquin, we also welcome Bishop Router to the parish for the first time. There will be tea in the hall for everyone afterwards and a chance to meet the new Parish Priest and the new Bishop!

Fr Chris' induction as Parish Priest of Aghyaran is scheduled to take place at the 7.30pm Vigil Mass on Saturday 7 November and then in Ardstraw West & Castlederg at the 11.00am Mass in Castlederg on Sunday 22 November. Further details next week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:
AGHYARAN: £1,262 & €11.
ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,756 & €74, made up of:
Castlederg £938 & €59, **Drumnabey** £557 & €15, **Dregish** £261. **DRUMQUIN:** £1,078.
Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In September these amounted to:
Aghyaran: £881 & €20 CRF £692; **Ardstraw West Castlederg:** £2,394; **Drumquin:** £2,245.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG Parish Draw: The October draw will take place after Mass in Dregish today.

SVP Meeting takes place this Wednesday, 28 October, in the Parochial House, Drumquin, at 7.30pm.

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We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Rosemary Donnell, late of 10 Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg, whose Funeral Mass took place in Strabane on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Rosemary's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

PLEASE NOTE the following dates for November Masses remembering those who have died in the past year.
A candle in remembrance of each of those who have died will be lit:

CASTLEDERG: Monday 2 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Joe Gallagher, Pat Carolan, James Murray, Delma MvGlynn, Ellen Sweeney, Tom McHugh, Derek Duggan, Pat Keenan, Marrie McMenamin, Ann T. Doherty, Angela Laird, Doris Gallagher, Colleen Vukusic (nee Masterson), Brendan Douglas, Charlie Logue, Christine Clarke, Michael Harper, Evelyn Baxter, Molly Carlin.

AGHYARAN: Friday 6 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Noel Doherty, Ellen Lynch, Peter Moss, Madge McNamee, Danny Gallen, Danny O'Donnell, Don Browne.

DRUMQUIN: Saturday 7 November, 5.00pm, remembering: Mickey McLaughlin, Margaret McLaughlin, Tommy Kearney, Margaret McLaughlin, Cameron Donnelly, Paddy Gallagher, Fiona Scott, Joe Campbell, Gerry O'Kane, Frankie Breen, Brendan Cassidy.

DREGISH: Sunday 8 November, 9.30am, remembering Kay Nugent.

DRUMNABEY: Sunday 8 November, 12.30pm, remembering: Hannah Devine, Terry Logue, Brendan (Bo) Lennon.

Families who have been bereaved in the past year are asked to check that the name of their loved one has been included above. If you have any query, please contact the Parish Office.

IVY'S DANCE – CASTLEDERG COMMITTEE OF CANCER RESEARCH UK: Sat 31 October, Scraghey Community Centre. Dancing from 9.30pm. Music by Charlie and Claire. Adm £8. Raffle on the night. Light refreshments served.

BEGINNERS' UPHOLSTERY CLASS in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, Thursday 5 November, 6.30pm to 9.00pm. Cost £10 and booking is essential. All materials supplied. For information or to book, contact Claire on 07818091136.

BOOK LAUNCH: Dregish History Group invite you to a Book Launch in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Fri 13 Nov, at 7.30pm; refreshments will be served. The Group has produced two books, available at the event for purchase. One contains a selection of interesting local history articles by members of the Dregish History Group called ***'Gathering Hidden Gems on the History of Dregish and the People Together'.*** The second is a history of the ***Clergy of Adrstraw West*** by Brian Devenney, edited by Fr McCawille. Thank you to NLH Fund and Rapid for their support.

THANK YOU: Deborah Lowry offers her thanks to all who supported in any way the ***Team Hope Garden Tea Party*** at her home in September. She is most appreciative of the generosity shown by the entire community and is delighted to share that the event raised almost £5,000. The funds raised will support Team Hope's longer-term development work, helping vulnerable families and communities overseas to build more secure and hopeful futures.

TEAM HOPE CHRISTMAS SHOE-BOX APPEAL for children in Africa and Eastern Europe: You are invited to fill a wrapped shoebox with gifts using the 4Ws - something to Write, Wash, Wear and Wow, and include a €6 contribution towards transport and delivery. Shoeboxes can be dropped off between 1 and 10 Nov at Castle Coffee, or Urban Barn/Pet Store, both in Castlederg. For further details, labels and guidance, visit www.teamhope.ie. Thank you, from Deborah Lowry and all at Team Hope!

As our parishes prepare to welcome Fr Chris next weekend, Fr Thomas and I take this opportunity to wish him every blessing in his ministry in Aghyaran, Ardstraw West & Castlederg and Drumquin.

Born in 1986, Fr Chris is a native of Leckpatrick Parish. His parents, Rosemary and Sean, live in Strabane. Fr Chris tells us that his three brothers, two nieces and a nephew form his closest family. Following school, Chris was employed for several years in an administrative role at the Oncology Department of Altnagelvin Hospital. He subsequently pursued seminary studies at St Malachy's College, Belfast, and St Patrick's College, Maynooth. Since ordination in June 2016, Fr Chris has ministered among the faith communities of St Eugene's Cathedral in Derry, Drumragh (Omagh), Limavady, Kilrea & Desertoghill, Errigal (Garvagh) and Granaghan (Swatragh).

Fr Chris says that, after spending the last five years 'on the missions' in Co Derry, he now looks forward to serving the people of the West Tyrone Pastoral Area. He and Kobe (the pet dog) will take up residence in Castlederg Parochial House at the end of the month.

Fr Chris brings many gifts to his ministry and, in giving generously of himself to serving the people entrusted to his care, I know that he will enjoy the support and encouragement of you all. I pray God's blessing on all that you will share and accomplish together.

Please keep Fr Chris in your prayers as he prepares to move to Castlederg and begin the next chapter of his priestly ministry in the West Tyrone Pastoral Area.

May God bless you all,

Fr Paul.

ARDMORE PARISH

Parish Newsletter

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME • 25 OCTOBER 2026 • YEAR A

Gospel Reflection | Matthew 22:34–40

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognise the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

Prayer for the Week • May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Sunday Readings | 1 November – All Saints

First Reading: Revelation 7:2–4, 9–14 • Psalm: 24:1–2, 3–4, 5–6
Second Reading: 1 John 3:1–3 • Gospel: Matthew 5:1–12

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: St Otteran, monk • Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles
Thursday: St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop • Friday: St John of Capistrano, priest
Saturday: St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Prayer, Worship & Vocations

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "with the joy of the Holy Spirit" that they took to the Gospel. We pray for future priests of our diocese, that they will experience the joy of the Spirit as they read, live and preach the Good News of God's love.

Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours Tuesday 3 November and 1 December, 8–9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Priesthood? Meeting in Derry on Sunday 8 November at 4 pm. Contact Fr Pat O'Hagan, Diocesan Vocations Director: pgoh2111@gmail.com or (028) 7938 6259.

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets Wednesday 28 October, 12.30–1.30 pm, at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas at Long Tower Church, Derry, 6 pm, beginning Sunday 25 October. Theme: "Make Me a Channel of Your Peace – Celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis." Each night includes the Rosary, Novena prayers and petitions, a guest talk, Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and Benediction. All welcome, especially those in need of healing. Webcam: https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Parish & Diocesan Events

6–8 NOV	**A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett** Termonbacca, Derry. Prayer, reflection and an opportunity to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact: termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or facebook.com/TermonbaccaDerry/
15 NOV	**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group – Golden Jubilee** Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing at Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration 9.30 am; concluding with afternoon Mass. Theme: "People of God's Delight" (Ps 149:4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. £40 including coffee and lunch. Book by 1 November: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.
19 NOV	**The Columban Young Adults – Holy Hour & Meditation** 7 pm, Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry. For ages 18–35. Meditation by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. New members welcome. Contact: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com.
20–22 NOV	**Abide Women's Conference** Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and the Nashville Dominicans. Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. Registration: Abide in His Love on Eventbrite.ie.
5 DEC	**St Patrick's, Dungannon – Charismatic Prayer Group Golden Jubilee** Servite Priory, Benburb, 11 am–3 pm, concluding with Mass. Theme: "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come." Everyone welcome.

Marriage & Family Life

ACCORD Derry – Marriage Preparation Courses In-person at the Everglades Hotel, Derry. Dates: 29–30 January, 19–20 February and 19–20 March 2027. Book at www.accordni.com.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend St Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo, Friday 9–Sunday 11 April 2027. Residential weekend for married couples, beginning Friday at 7.30 pm and ending Sunday at 4.30 pm. Online booking only: www.marriageencounter.ie.

Job Opportunity

Choir Director – St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry Experienced Choir Director sought for 10 hours per week to lead the cathedral choir and enhance worship through music. Application pack: (028) 7126 2302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, or by email, by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer; applications from all communities welcome.

ARDMORE PARISH • Growing together in faith, hope and love.